holding the area around Bridge 2 while 4 Grenadiers less one company was deployed around Bridge 1. Just above the junction of the Nam Ka Chu and the Nyamjang Chu, Khenzemane was the headquarters of 5 Assam Rifles with one wing of ninety men and a company of 4 Grenadiers under its command.

Commanded by Lieutenant Colonel B. S. Ahluwalia, 1/9 GR less three companies was strung out on the forward slope of Tsangdhar in depth to (i.e. behind) 2 Rajput's Alpha Company, which was deployed at Bridge 3. One of its companies was on its way to reinforce the Punjabis at Bridge 5 while another was at the brigade's rear at Tsangdhar itself. Ever since 10 October, the officers of the various units had been trying to maintain the security of the large gaps that existed between these positions by carrying out extensive day and night patrolling. Due to the poor visibility and the nature of the terrain, that was an almost impossible task. The gap between Bridge 5 and Temporary Bridge (the left flank of 2 Rajput) was an astounding nine kilometres, a distance that took eighteen hours to cover along the southern side of the Nam Ka Chu. Apart from the vast frontage being held by the Rajputs, there was no interconnecting support between companies, or even platoons.

Though the battalions worked round the clock to try and improve their defences, they were severely limited on nearly all fronts. There was an acute shortage of even basic items like digging tools. 2 Rajput was particularly handicapped, having handed over the bulk of their equipment to 6 Kumaon at Walong. The men were short on all items; there was no question of snow clothing and each man only had a single blanket, as protection from the cold. The four 4.2-inch mortars deployed on the forward slopes of the Tsangdhar slopes were useless, as they had no ammunition. There were four 81.5-mm (3-inch) mortars with the unit with a total of sixty bombs. There was one Vickers machine gun with limited ammunition. As regards small arms, each LMG had seventeen magazines of ammunition, while each soldier had on him his pouch ammunition along with two grenades. The few 2-inch mortars available were also redundant as there were no bombs to go with the firing tubes.

The 2 Rajput positions had no artillery support. The rest of 7 Brigade had four 75-mm para guns that had been airdropped at Tsangdhar but after they were recovered, only two were serviceable. Two hundred and sixty rounds of ammunition had also been salvaged from the drops, but the